

Going Home with Flea Allergy Dermatitis

A guide for your cat's recovery at home

Your cat was treated for flea allergy dermatitis — a skin reaction caused by sensitivity to flea bites — while in our care at the shelter. Any medications your cat received are listed in your adoption paperwork.

What to Expect

- Flea allergy dermatitis is a skin reaction to flea saliva. Even a single flea bite can trigger intense itching in a sensitive cat.
- Common signs include scabs and hair loss around the neck, back, and base of the tail, along with frequent scratching, licking, or overgrooming.
- Itching and skin irritation should gradually improve as fleas are eliminated and treatment takes effect, though full healing of the skin can take several weeks.

Home Care

- Give all medications exactly as directed, including any flea prevention started at the shelter.
- Use a veterinarian-recommended flea preventive year-round, even indoors — ask before using any over-the-counter flea product, as some are unsafe for cats.
- Treat all pets in the household, not just the affected cat, since fleas spread easily between animals.
- Wash bedding regularly and vacuum floors and furniture frequently to help remove fleas and eggs from the environment.

Contact Your Veterinarian If Your Cat Has:

- Continued scratching, licking, or hair loss despite flea treatment
- Open sores, scabs that are getting worse, or signs of skin infection
- Redness, swelling, or odor from the affected skin
- Signs of discomfort, restlessness, or decreased appetite

Follow-Up Care

Schedule a follow-up visit with your veterinarian within **2–4 weeks** after adoption to check the skin and confirm the flea allergy is under control.

Bring your adoption paperwork so your veterinarian knows what treatment was already given.